

ENG 101
Lesson -11

Our main concern is with improving your comprehension. There is a relationship between reading speed and reading comprehension. You may think that if you read rapidly your comprehension will suffer. This is a false assumption. As you push yourself to read faster you may find that you comprehend less

One cause of slow reading is VOCALIZATION - the forming the sounds of each word even though you may not say them aloud. Vocalization is very common among our students. Its is a sure sign that the reader is a poor reader. So, learn to read with your eyes and mind and not with your lips. In simple words learn to read silently

If you learn to recognize and understand the principles and methods of writing - rhetoric - it will help improve your reading. If you learn to understand why a piece of text or writing was written, what it says, both in overall statement and major subpoints, and how the author or writer has made those major statements and the minor but parts fit in - it will help improve your understanding of the reading text.

All successful writers work along these lines. The way they write will provide answers to the three questions - Why? What? And How?

MAKING INFERENCES

You are familiar with the expression “to read between the lines”, which means that you pick up ideas that are not directly stated in the material you are reading. The writer is giving or making a suggestion but stating it directly i.e. he is implying something. These implied ideas are often important for a full understanding of what the writer means. It is this discovering of ideas in writing that are not stated directly that is called “making inferences” or drawing conclusions.

In reading also we make logical jumps from the information given or stated directly to ideas that are not stated directly. i.e. we make statements or draw conclusions about what is not known on the basis of what is known or given. So, to draw inferences the reader uses all the clues provided by the writer, his own experience i.e. the readers own experience and logic.

Read the sentences given on your screen and put a tick mark by the inference most logically based on the information in the sentence.

Sohail always sits in the last row of the classroom.

- a. Sohail dislikes his college courses.
- b. Sohail is unprepared for his class.
- c. Sohail feels uncomfortable sitting in the front row
- d. Sohail is farsighted

The given sentence tells us nothing about how Sohail feels about his college courses, how prepared he is, or how well he sees. So answers *a*, *b* or *d* are possibilities, but none is directly suggested by the sentence. The correct answer is therefore c. Based on the information we are given, we can conclude only that Sohail – for some reason – does not like sitting in the front. We are not given enough information to know why he feels this way.

Remember your inferences will be stronger if you don't jump to conclusions that are unsupported or that are only very weakly supported by the available information.

